

YEAR 10 SCIENCE (ADJUSTED)
RESEARCH ASSIGNMENT - AUSTRALIAN BUSHFIRES

NAME: SOLUTIONS

MARK: 27 ~~26~~ ~~27~~

Using the Stile lesson The Australian Bushfires, answer the following questions. You will need to work through each part carefully and write down the information.

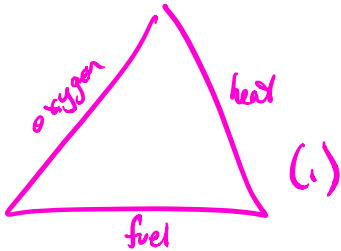
1. How big is the area burned in Australia? *compared to the fires in the Amazon?* ^{recent} (1 mark)

• Much larger than the Amazon

2. What were the weather ~~conditions~~ conditions that contributed to the disastrous fire conditions? (2 marks)

- Strong, gusty winds.
- Drought.
- Heat waves

3. What is the "fire triangle"? Put a picture of it here and explain what it shows. ² (2 marks)



- Oxygen, fuel and heat are required for a fire to burn.

4. Name two major causes of the recent fires in Australia. i.e. How were they started? (2 marks)

- Lightning
- Fire bugs.

5. (a) What is meant by the term "climate change"? (1 mark)

• How the weather has changed over a long period of time.

- (b) CO₂ is a major greenhouse gas. Which activity of humans is **most responsible** for producing lots of CO₂? (1 mark)

• Burning coal, oil and natural gas.

- three*
- (c) List ~~two~~ ^{three} effects of climate change. 3
(2 marks)
- Temp increase
 - Oceans are rising
 - Birds not flying far south for the winter
 - Melting ice caps
 - Flowers blooming earlier
 - Snow is melting sooner

6. Write true (T) or false (F) for each of the following statements about bushfires and climate change. **Look for a fact sheet to help you with these questions.**

(6 marks)

- Bushfire risk is rising. T
- Climate change is not influencing bushfires. F
- Fuel is always the main factor in fire risk. F
- Recent hot weather (last 5 years) is within normal range. F
- Australia's climate is changing. T
- The costs of bushfires and other weather-related disasters is increasing. T

7. (a) What was the date of the highest average temperature in Australia? (1 mark)

18 December 2019

- (b) What was the average temperature in Australia on this date? (1 mark)

41.9°C

- (c) How much has Australia warmed since 1950? (1 mark)

Over 1°C

8. How does climate change make bushfires worse? (3 marks)

- Increase the number of heatwaves.
- More droughts and dry weather.
- Longer bushfire seasons.

9. Suggest three ways in you, as an individual, can help fight climate change.

(3 marks)

- Walk, ride, use public transport.
- Switch off lights, TV, computers.
- Eat less meat and reduce food waste
- Raise awareness and encourage action on climate change.